

English Guide @ Level A2

2026

Abstract

Built by Carmen Crai covering tenses, prepositions, adverbs, modal verbs, linking words and more, up to A2 level.

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EASY AND PRACTICAL GUIDE

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This A2 edition keeps the core, everyday grammar (present/past/basic future tenses, articles, the essential modals, basic comparisons, and the most common irregular verbs) and sets aside the more advanced structures for later. The Appendix tables still include some higher-level material for anyone who wants to look ahead.

1. Start

This course is built around the priorities below — the grammar and vocabulary areas that make the biggest difference to how clearly and confidently you communicate in English.

[1. Grammar](#): present, past and future tenses (simple, continuous, passive, perfect).

1.1. For **polite conversations** we use:

- present/past/future **passive** simple for instance: “The contract is signed”
- **modal** verbs for example: “Should we ask the client first?”
- **past continuous** e.g.: “I was wondering/thinking if you could help me?”

[2. Prepositions](#): at, in, on, about, for, by, with

[3. Adverbs](#): words ending in “ly” that usually describe how an action is done

[4. Comparison adjectives](#): six types (equality, inequality, comparative, superlative...)

[5. Possessives](#): 's / s' and possessive pronouns (mine, yours, theirs, his, hers)

[6. Linking words](#): to connect ideas clearly (see the Linking Words chapter)

[7. The gerund](#) “ing” form: as a noun and after prepositions

[8. Verbs \(V3\) that become adjectives](#), and nouns that act as adjectives

[9. Modal verbs](#): can, could, would, should, must, may, might...

10. Professional / workplace verbs and vocabulary — see [Appendix J — Extended Professional Words Table](#)

11. At A2 level I recommend outside this **guide** to work on: **translations**, **error corrections** and to take **1h** per week of **private lessons**!

2. Grammar: Tenses

In a professional workplace, I only recommend the below grammar to be used:

	SIMPLE		SIMPLE PASSIVE		CONTINUOUS	
PRESENT	Action in the present taking place regularly , never or several times.		To be (am/are/is) verb describes a person/animal/object : adjectives, job, nationality, location, feelings, presence.		Focus is on the action , not on the person/door.	
	I You She/He/It We They		I You She/He/It We They		I You She/He/It We They	
	A: He speaks . They speak . N: He doesn't speak. They don't speak. Q: Does he speak? Do they speak? Q: Doesn't he speak? Does he not speak?		A: He is here/good/German. They are great. N: He isn't here/good/German. He is not here/good. They aren't great. They are not great. Q+: Is he here? Are they good people? Q: Isn't he German? Is he not here? Aren't they here yet? Are they not here yet?		A: The task is done. The contract is signed. N: The task is not / isn't done. The contract is not / isn't signed. Q+: Is the task done? Q: Isn't the contract signed? Is the contract not signed yet?	
ALWAYS; EVERY; NEVER; NORMALLY; OFTEN; SELDOM; SOMETIMES; USUALLY						AT THE MOMENT; JUST; JUST NOW; LISTEN!; LOOK!; NOW; RIGHT NOW
PAST	Action in the past taking place once, never or several times.		Focus is on the action, not on the person who does it.		Action going on at a certain in the past.	
	I You She/He/It We They		I You She/He/It We They		I You She/He/It We They	
	A: He spoke . They spoke . N: He didn't speak. They didn't speak. Q: Did he speak? Did they speak? Q: Didn't he speak? Didn't they speak? Did he not speak? Did they not speak?		A: The task was done. The contract was signed. N: The task was not / wasn't done. The contract was not / wasn't signed. Q+: Was the task done? Q: Wasn't the contract signed? Was the contract not signed yet?		A: He was speaking. They were speaking. N: He was not / wasn't speaking. They were not speaking. Q+: Was he speaking? Q: Weren't they speaking? Were they not speaking?	
YESTERDAY; 2 MINUTES AGO; IN 1990; THE OTHER DAY; LAST FRIDAY						ALL; WHOLE; ENTIRE WEEK; WHILE; AS LONG AS
FUTURE	Planned action in the future.		Not applicable for Level A2		Action that is going on at a certain time in the future.	
	I You She/He/It We They		I You She/He/It We They		I You She/He/It We They	
	A: He will speak. They will speak. N: He won't speak. He will not speak. They won't speak. They will not speak. Q: Will he speak? Q: Won't he speak? Will he not speak?				A: He will be speaking. They will be speaking. N: He won't be speaking. He will not be speaking. They won't be speaking. They will not be speaking. Q: Will he be speaking? Q: Won't he be speaking? Will they not be speaking?	
IN A YEAR; NEXT; TOMORROW						IN ONE YEAR; TOMORROW; NEXT WEEK

For further information, see [Appendix A — Extended Tenses Table](#).

3. Prepositions

Prepositions link nouns, pronouns or gerunds to the rest of the sentence. The three most common are at, in and on, used for time and place. A verb placed immediately after a preposition must take the -ing form.

We arrived at the station at 6 p.m. (precise time / point)

She was born in 1990 and lives in London. (year / city — larger area)

The meeting is on Monday, on the 5th floor. (day / surface)

Further usage:

When	In
parts of the day	☐ in the morning/afternoon/evening
months	☐ in January/February
seasons	☐ in (the) spring/summer/autumn/winter
years, centuries, decades	☐ in 2016 ☐ in the 21st century ☐ in the 80s
other time phrases	☐ in the past ☐ in the future ☐ in the last few years/months/weeks/days

When	On
days	☐ on Monday/Tuesday etc. ☐ on my birthday ☐ on New Year's Day ☐ On weekend
dates	☐ on 30 July ☐ on the second of August

When	At
clock times	☐ at 6 o'clock ☐ at 9.30 ☐ at 13.00
mealtimes and breaks	☐ at breakfast time ☐ at lunchtime ☐ at dinner time ☐ at break time
other time phrases	☐ at night ☐ at weekends the weekend ☐ at Christmas/Easter

For further information and prepositions, see [Appendix G — Extended Prepositions Notes](#).